

PURPOSE: To implement a Senator Mentorship Program to help new Senators get accustomed

INTRODUCED BY: Sonora Foster

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS AND SCIENCE:

SECTION ONE (REASONING):

Senate can be a stressful environment at first on top of the adjustment to MSMS life. Juniors and new senior Senators often have a lot of questions that they might be afraid to ask the SGA officers. If students are paired with a returning Senator, they will have someone to ask these questions to and the stress of the Senate will be lessened.

SECTION TWO (PROPOSED ACTION):

Returning Senators will be placed with a new junior Senator, and if needed, a new senior Senator before the first meeting. The Returning senators will be encouraged to reach out to the new Senators to see if they have any questions or nerves about the upcoming term. The Senator groups will sit beside each other for the first few meetings while the new Senators are learning the ropes of the Senate.

SECTION THREE (APPENDIX):

Denise Quedado (Junior Senator):

“I’ve been excited for Senate since I heard about it at NSO, but I was honestly really intimidated. Just how serious it was. I was really really intimidated by having to propose a bill or resolution at all. I think being able to have a returning Senator be able to help guide the junior senators through writing legislation and the interworking of Senate would be really beneficial. First, I think I would save us time from legislation that isn’t at its best possible iteration by having junior senators work through it with their mentor. Secondly, I think that having a mentor can make Senate not less serious, but less intimidating for first time Senators.”

Anonymous Senior Senator:

“This resolution will be very good at introducing juniors and getting them comfortable with Senate as long as there are clear obligations for the mentors and thought put behind who is paired with whom.”

Anonymous Senior:

“I think this is a great idea because big+littles really work. For example frats do it so people can get more used to being there. Our emissary program is essentially a mentorship but instead of 1 or 2 people it's about 4 to 5 to a group with your emissary. I think it's really beneficial and should definitely be implemented into Senate so people can adjust easier.